Deploying Express Apps in Render

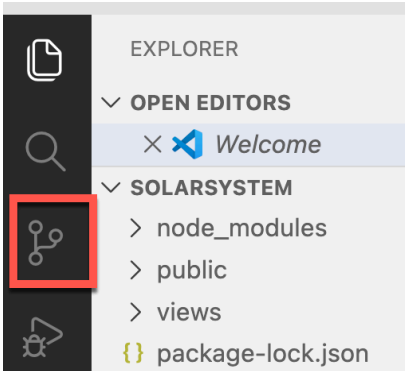
GitHub Pages doesn't support server-side programming, so we'll need to use a different platform (render.com). For the remaining labs and assignments, create your local folder at the same level as the "github.io" folder, not inside it.

1. **Push your local folder to GitHub as a New Repository.**

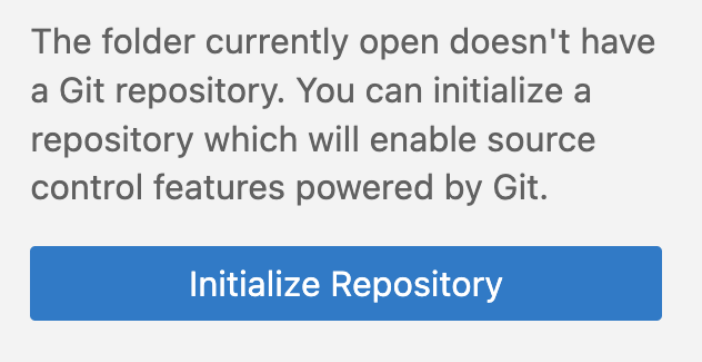
   There are several ways to do this. You could use the terminal window if you're familiar with GitHub commands. Optionally, you can do it through Visual Studio Code following these steps.

   a. In VSCode, go to **File > Open Folder** and then select the folder of your Express app.

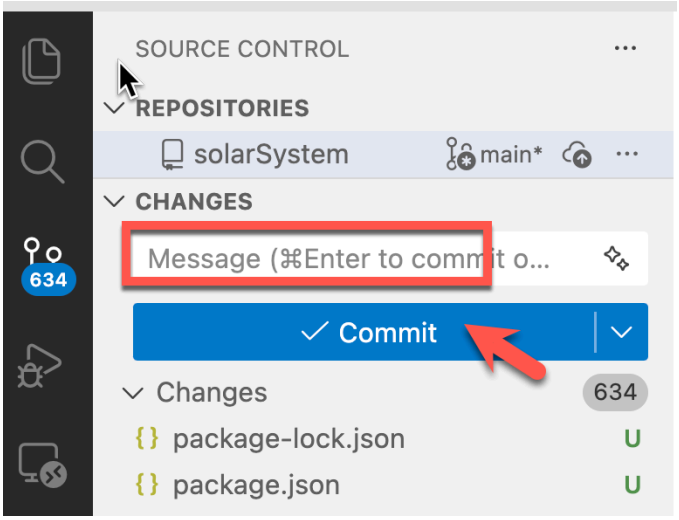
   b. From the vertical icon bar, click on "**Source Control**" (third icon)



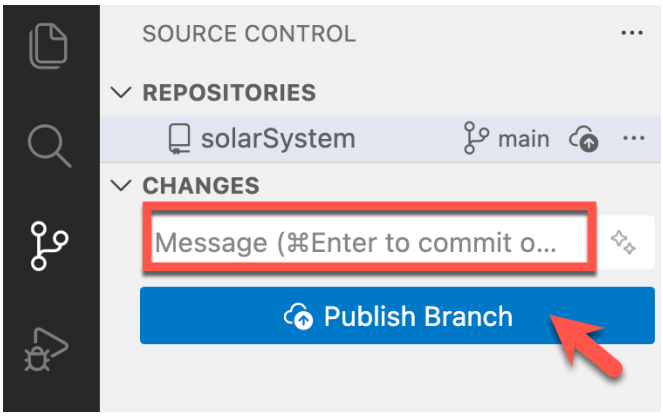
   c. Click on the "Initialize Repository" button



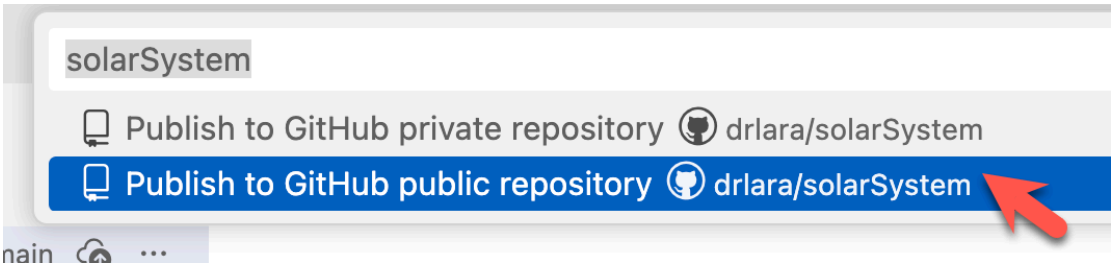
d. Type a message and then click on the "**Commit**" button



e. Type a message and then click on the "**Publish Branch**" button



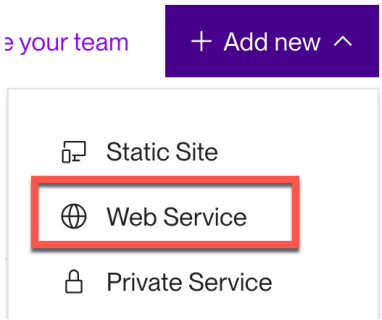
f. At the top of the window, you should see a dropdown menu asking you whether the repository should be private or public. Select public.



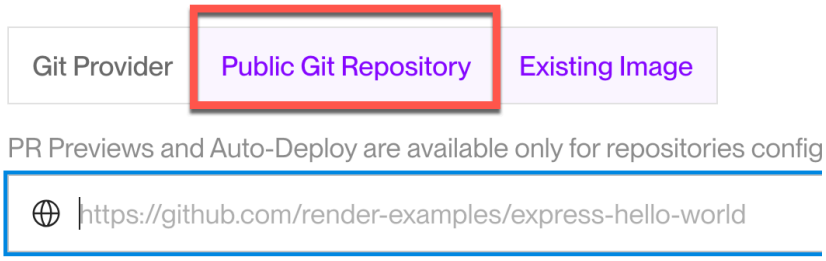
g. After a few seconds, you should see a pop-up window in the bottom-right corner. Click on "**Open on GitHub**"

2. Deploy to Render.

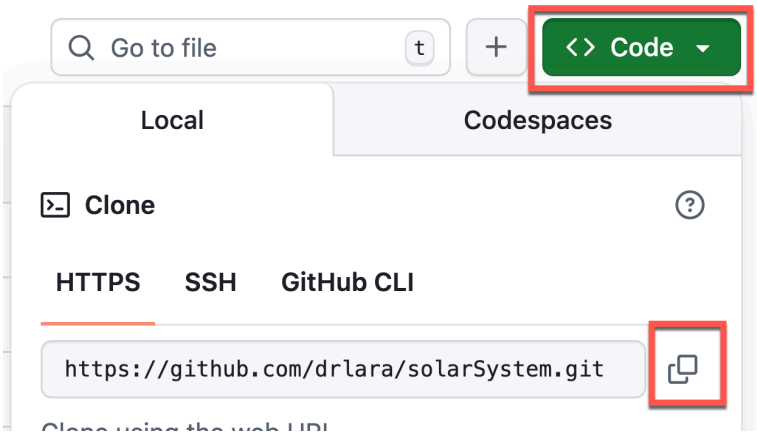
a. Log in to render.com and then click on "**Add new**" and then "**Web Service**"



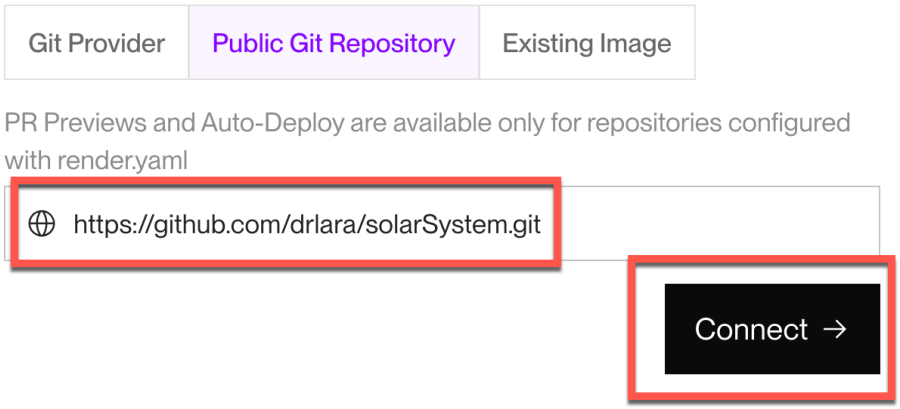
b. A new window will show up.
Click on "**Public Git Repository**"



c. Go to GitHub, click on "**Code**" and then copy the URL to your git repository (using HTTPS)

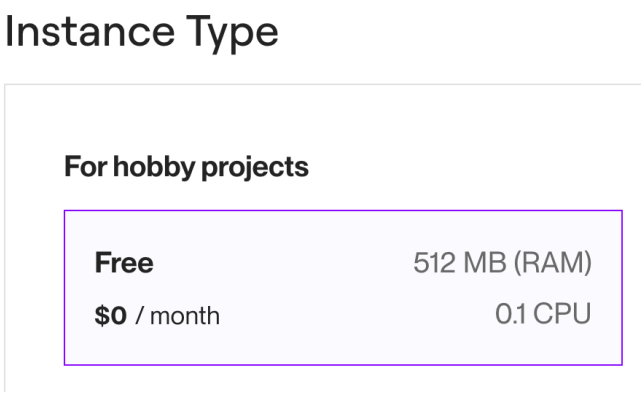


d. Go back to Render and paste your repository URL and then click on "**Connect**"



e. A new window will be displayed. Scroll down to the "**Start Command**" section and type: **node index.mjs**

f. In the "Instance Type" section, select "Free"



g. Scroll all the way down and click on "**Deploy Web Service**". And that's it! After a few seconds, you should get the link to your app!